

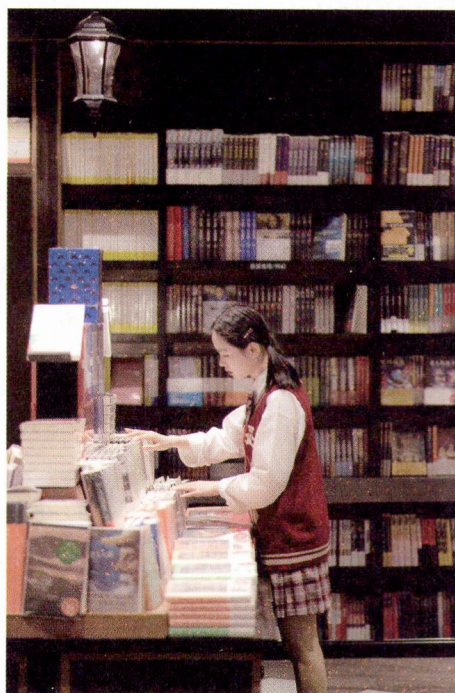
Part 1 Words in Context

Passage 1: Reading Literature Should Be Valued U2-1

Despite research and expert **opinions** on the importance of reading from an early age, the reading of literature often seems lost in today's education. In fact, this lack of **emphasis** on reading is a sign that some changes need to be made **particularly** with the way students are taught.

Some might ask, why should children read literature? How do stories **compare** with the learning of facts and **practical** information? Studies show that the most powerful ways of learning are experience and action. While children can **develop** many skills through actions like doing **experiments** and taking **risks**, there are many important things that cannot be learned in such ways—things like feelings and **emotions**, problem solving, and relationships. **Furthermore**, research has shown how deep reading gives children a different kind of experience **compared** to that of learning facts and information. Stories help children **reflect** on right and wrong, good and **evil**. Keen readers of literature have a better understanding of themselves and others, and they are more **capable** of making decisions. Moreover, young children who enjoy story time with their parents show a greater **awareness** of social bonding and relationships with others when they reach school age. There is no doubt that classic stories **inspire** the youth more than modern **bestsellers**.

Unfortunately, too often even the best schools seem to provide only a **limited** chance for children to enjoy literature. **Although** they read classic stories at school, there is simply not enough free time for kids to read outside the classroom. Sure, there are more than enough reading **materials**—bookshops are



full of story books, and most of them are of good quality, but the key is to **increase** people's awareness of the power of reading literature and allow children the time that is needed to enjoy a good book.

As **author** Ursula Le Guin once said, "There have been great **societies** that did not use the wheel, but there have been no societies that did not tell stories." As countries **promotes** decision making and shared values through education, the value of literature should be made a **priority** in **nurturing** the future of mankind.

